

EXERCISE · MEMORY ARCHITECTURE

structure.md + Beads

Organize your project so things have a home — and track your work so nothing slips.

What you're making

Two habits that work together: a `structure.md` that says **where everything lives**, and a **Beads** task tracker that follows **each task's whole life**. A tidy project gives your information a home; the tracker gives your work a memory.

Your task

PART 1 — Organize (structure.md)

Sort your project files into clear folders (e.g. `notes/`, `instructions/`, `data/`). Add a `structure.md` that explains where each kind of thing lives. Then **test it** — ask your agent to find one file and confirm it goes straight there.

PART 2 — Track (Beads)

Set up Beads by **giving the link below to your Claude** and asking it to set up Beads as instructed there:

```
https://github.com/gastownhall/beads
```

For example, paste this to Claude: *"Set up Beads in my project, following the instructions here: <https://github.com/gastownhall/beads>"* — and let it do the setup for you.

Once it's set up, **run the whole system end-to-end to see whether it actually works** — create a task, open it, move it through its states (in progress → blocked/waiting → done), and close it. The point is to **watch the tracker work**, not to hit a task quota.

 **Remember:** Beads is **not just a to-do list — it's a task tracker**. A to-do list only shows what's left; a tracker follows the whole life of each task (opened → in progress → blocked/waiting → done).

Hint — how to do it

Refresher + Example — structure.md

One short file that maps your folders. Keep it to a line per folder.

```
# structure.md
notes/      → my notes & journal (memory.md lives here)
instructions/ → rules for the agent (CLAUDE.md)
data/       → raw data & exports
decisions/  → decision.md
```

Refresher + Example — Beads tracker

Each task is an item you open and close; the status shows where it stands.

```
.beads - task tracker
☑ Write the script           done
▶ Render the video          in progress
⌚ Get reviewer approval    waiting on review
☐ Add captions              to do
```

Tip: after you build it, ask your agent to "find the data" — watch it go straight to `data/` . That's a well-organized project.

Final step — push it to GitHub

Once both are set up, **commit and push them to your existing project's GitHub repository** — the same project you've been working in this week, **not a new repo**. From your project folder:

```
git add structure.md .beads
git commit -m "Add structure.md and Beads tracker"
git push
```

☑ **Done when:** `structure.md` exists (plus one example of your agent finding a file) and you've **run Beads end-to-end** — a task moving through its states and closing — confirming the whole tracker works — **and both are pushed to GitHub.**